



MIDWEST GOLF LEAGUE – 2026

REV 10/9/25

The following information will help you understand the operations of our league...

The Midwest Men's Golf League (MGL) is a long-standing member of the CDGA. The MGL is open to all regular dues paying club members over the age of 21 (Junior, Limited and/or Social Members are excluded).

The MGL is divided into 2 divisions (Hogan & Nicklaus) and typically include 3-4 clubs per division. The divisions are decided by the order of finish in the previous season which also include the Roundup (League Finals). Historically, new/returning clubs have started in the Hogan Division. The top four clubs in regular season points qualify to participate in the Roundup.

Captains

Prior to the 15th of April, we ask each captain to email a list of potential players to our Golf Genius Liaison (TBA) who will assist the MGL with inputting player data into the system as we use this as our scoring component each match/season. An Excel spreadsheet will be provided to each captain for completion and will include the following information:

1. Club Name
2. Player's Last Name
3. Player's First Name
4. C – Team Captain
5. Member Number (your club's billing number) which can be used for incidentals purchased during a match date.
6. GHIN number
7. Player's Cell Number (optional)
8. Player's Email address (optional)
9. FTO (Yes or No) The Forward Tee Option can be selected by all players that are 70 and older. (one tee forward)

We recommend that each captain maintain an updated Excel file or other list of their team members which can be updated on an as-needed' basis and shared with our Golf Genius Liaison & MGL Executive Board.

Golf Professionals

Required Printing (could be revised slightly)

Score cards, cart signs, recaps and a player listing report should be printed by the host Golf Professional.

The score cards are printed on the white stock score card available from the CDGA. The cart signs are printed on the green bordered stock also available from the CDGA. Optionally, there is a Tags Report - print on 3 x 10 stock labels.

All other printing is done on standard 8 ½ x 11 stock paper.

Golf Professionals Section Continued

1:00 p.m. Shotgun Start

At 12:55 the host Golf Professional is asked to share:

1. Special course instruction if any (i.e. local rules, course markings, etc.)
2. Encourage players to watch SPEED OF PLAY.
3. USGA Rules apply except the "One Ball Rule."
4. Maximum handicap is 21
5. Should there be an in-match rules question, the player should contact the Golf Shop for a ruling; if unable to obtain an answer, players are asked to hit 2 balls and let the host Golf Professional after completion of the round.
6. The host Golf Professional should make sure that the Golf Genius input code for each foursome is listed on the scorecard and remind the field that at least one player will enter their scores after each hole.
7. Players that start on a CTP Par 3 should bring the signs in after they finish their 18th hole.

Additionally:

Forward Tee Option (FTO)

The MGL allows all players regardless of handicaps that are age 70 or over to use the FTO. Players' handicaps are adjusted accordingly. FTO for the MGL is one tee forward from the day's tee. Once a player decides to use FTO, he must continue for the entire season. Players that attain age 70 during the season can elect to use the FTO after their birthday. Please note that all players participating in the CDGA Cup Finals must play the same set of tees, however.

Tees:

The tee markers for the both divisions are to be set at no more than 6500 yards +/- 100 yards. Again, the FTO is one tee marker forward.

Pin Positions

Captains and host Golf Professionals should make sure pin positions are 6 – 6 – 6. This will affect the speed of play.

Closest to the Pin (CTP)

There should be 4 CTPs set up. Please label the CTP as follows:

- the first two par 3's are set for players with a handicap of 10 or less
- the second two par 3's are to be set for players with an 11 - 21 handicap.

(4) \$70.00 golf shop certificates will be awarded to winners of the CTP.

Scoring

At least one person from each foursome will record all scores into Golf Genius after each hole. Each team will also keep a score card. After the completion of the round, each foursome should meet to compare score cards and all players should sign both cards. A designated member of the respective club in each foursome should meet with the golf shop staff to make sure all scores were correctly input into Golf Genius.

Match Results

Upon completion of the day's matches, we ask that the host Golf Professional provide/post a summary of the results (club v club matches, Stableford game, CTP's) on a white scoring sheet in the dining room where dinner is being served.

Carts

Participating clubs in the MGL have agreed to a **\$30 cart fee per player.**

Golf Professionals Section Continued

Pro Shop Certificates

The host Golf Professional should have **2 \$70 golf shop gift certificates per participating club** prepared to presented to an MGL Executive Board Member prior to dinner taking place.

Ex: if there are 6 clubs participating in that week's matches, 12 golf shop gift certificates will be presented to MGL Executive Board Member. For each participating club that brings 4 alternates to the match, they will be given an additional \$70 golf shop gift certificate.

Rain Outs

Each host Golf Professional must decide if his/her course is playable on the date selected. Generally, this decision should be made prior to 9:00 a.m. the day of the match but can also be made sooner (i.e. the day/evening before the match date).

If carts are restricted to CPO (Cart Path Only) but the course remains playable, the match should be played.

Range balls

Unlimited range balls are to be furnished at no additional charge to the players.

Captains/Co Captains:

Each club has a Captain and is encouraged to have a Co-Captain. The Captain and/or Co-Captain will upload their roster into the MGL website as well as submit an email to the host Golf Professional & the MGL Executive Board by 12 p.m., 2 days preceding the actual day of the match.

Cost

As of the 2025 season, the cost per player per match is \$130. This includes the greens/cart fee, dinner and associated league fees/expenses/prizes (including the above-mentioned CTP & \$70 golf shop gift certificates).

Players are responsible for paying for any alcohol and/or soft drinks; any on course purchases should be paid in cash and/or billed back to the player's respective club.

TIPS

The MGL will take responsibility for tipping the golf shop staff. All players are asked to contribute \$5 at their table to cover the tip to the food service staff.

Club Rosters/Match Format

Club rosters consist of 8 individuals. Matches are played at full handicap with a max of 21. Each foursome plays off the lowest handicap player. Clubs are encouraged to bring Alternates. Matches shotgun at 1:00 p.m.

Players are positioned on their club's roster based on handicap index (lowest index first).

Player 1/2 versus Opponent 1/2

Player 3/4 versus Opponent 3/4

Player 5/6 versus Opponent 5/6

Player 7/8 versus Opponent 7/8

Each player will play a handicapped best ball match against their opponent for 3 points (1 for front, 1 for back, 1 for total). Their will also be a team match with both players playing their opponents for 3 points (1 for front, 1 for back, 1 for total).

Captains/Co-Captains Section Continued

Within the foursome, there will be 9 total points up for grabs and 36 overall points to be won for the day.

*** please note that the MGL is in the process of evaluating its By-Laws as it relates to how points will be awarded based on clubs that field an incomplete roster.

Captains/ Co-Captains Dinner

The MGL hosts a Captains Dinner annually. Guests must be invited/approved by the MGL Executive Board. The purpose of this dinner is to discuss/review key components of our league and vote on any proposed changes in our By-Laws.

Our 2026 event will be held on Thursday, February 12th in the Whealey Room at Boulder Ridge CC. Cocktails/Hors d' Oeuvres to be served at 6:15 p.m. with league discussions & dinner to follow.

Manager – Food and Beverage

Traditionally, we have had up to 20 players arrive early for lunch prior to the day's match. We have advised them that they should order off of the club's lunch menu and either pay with cash or bill back to their respective club.

Dinner for Match Dates

To improve upon the quality of the dinner that the MGL presents, we have increased the fee paid to the host club to \$55.00.

Hors d' Oeuvres should be ready at 5:30 p.m. with a buffet style dinner beginning at 6:15 p.m. We also encourage a dessert/sweets/ice cream table be provided. *** an example menu from Boulder Ridge CC is included on the last page

Players are responsible for drinks other than water/coffee/tea/lemonade and should be paid for in cash and/or billed back to their respective club.

Additionally, we would like the dinner tables to have a card identifying each club. If there are too many players from one club for one table, please distribute the chairs so that that club has a similar number of players at two tables with a card identifying each table as that club's table.

Additional Notes

CDGA League Fee

Each club is charged an annual CDGA LEAGUE fee of \$150.00 and it is collected at our annual Captains Dinner. This fee pays the cost of the CDGA Playoffs and other league expenses.

If the League Dues are not paid by the time a club is scheduled to host their event, all unpaid League Dues will be subtracted from the amount a club will receive when they host their event.

MGL Round-Up (League Finals):

The winner of the MGL Roundup will compete in the CDGA Cup against other clubs that have won their respective league in the Greater Chicago area.

The winner of the CDGA Cup plays the winner from the State of Wisconsin the following Spring.

Additional Notes Continued

End of Season Payouts

The Final Four teams compete for prize money at the Roundup. We also pay out the participating Captains for their season-long efforts.

Captains have typically used these winnings to offset costs associated with team shirts, team party, etc.

Alternates play in an 18-hole Stableford Event at the Round-Up (both individual and team events) for golf shop certificates and cash.

All cash payouts mentioned are dependent upon the state of our treasury and Captains/Players must be present at the time the funds are distributed.

Hole in One Award:

A payout of \$400.00 will be awarded for any Hole in Ones. If there are 2 or more hole in ones on the same day players will split the \$400.00 fee.

Travel Trophy: Roundup Winners

2022 – Eagle Brook CC

2023 – Royal Fox CC

2024 & 2025 – Morris CC

Match Schedule

We make every effort to accommodate participating clubs so that there are no conflicts with their internal event schedule (i.e. Member Guest, Member Member, Presidents Cup, etc.).

We also try not to conflict with the CDGA's Senior League Schedule as many of our clubs have teams in multiple CDGA Leagues.

Captains are tasked with determining their respective match date and a tentative schedule is generally established at our Captains Dinner in February.

MGL Executive Board Contact Info

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SAMPLE DINNER MENU (Boulder Ridge CC)

5:30 PM - Hors d' Oeuvres (Buffet Style)

BBQ Meatballs, Mushroom Caps stuffed with Italian Sausage, Assorted Vegetables, Chicken, Quesadillas.

6:15 PM – Dinner (Buffet Style)

Roasted Pork Chop w/Apple Brandy,
Grecian Chicken Breast,
Horseradish-Crusted Salmon,
Double Baked Potato,
Green Beans Almondine,
Boulder Salad, Roma Salad,

Dessert (Ice Cream Bar)

Beverages Included

Coffee, Iced Tea, Tea, Lemonade, Water